

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 814

By Watson

A RESOLUTION to recognize Howard J. Kittell on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in public service; and

WHEREAS, Howard J. Kittell is one such individual, who has retired after a distinguished and purpose-filled career in public service, culminating in sixteen years of exceptional service as president and chief executive officer of the Andrew Jackson Foundation; and

WHEREAS, during his tenure, Mr. Kittell has received credit for a number of projects that have ultimately advanced the mission and the reputation of the Andrew Jackson Foundation, including restoration of The Hermitage Mansion, the log slave cabins, the Cabin-by-the-Spring, The Hermitage Church, and the Tulip Grove Mansion; and

WHEREAS, additional projects included infrastructure improvements and renovations to several buildings, such as the Andrew Jackson Center; the creation of the award-winning "Andrew Jackson: Born for a Storm" exhibit; the publication of an illustrated Andrew Jackson biography and the Hermitage Guidebook; and the production of the introductory film *Jackson*, among other educational materials; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Mr. Kittell recently received the 2025 Lewis R. Donelson Award in recognition of his leadership and support of The Hermitage and its preservation efforts; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Howard Kittell has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the unbridled respect and admiration of his colleagues and community alike; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we extend to Howard J. Kittell our heartfelt wishes for a happy and fulfilling retirement, applaud his dedication to the Andrew Jackson Foundation, and wish him much happiness and every continued success in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.